ACME CORPORATION

Human Resources Department

Code of Conduct & Ethics Policy

Policy Reference: HR-POL-001

Policy ID:	HR-POL-001	**Version:**	4.2
Effective Date:	2024-01-01	**Last Reviewed:**	2023-12-01
Policy Owner:	HR Director	**Approved By:**	Chief Executive Officer
Compliance Required:	Yes – All Employees	**Next Review:**	12 months from effective date

1. Policy Statement

Acme Corporation is committed to the highest standards of ethical business conduct. All employees, officers, directors, and contractors are expected to act with integrity, honesty, and respect in all professional interactions, both internal and external.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees (full-time, part-time, temporary), contractors, consultants, interns, and board members of Acme Corporation and its subsidiaries worldwide.

3. Core Principles

3.1 Integrity: Act honestly and transparently in all business dealings. Never misrepresent facts or conceal relevant information.

3.2 Respect: Treat all colleagues, customers, and partners with dignity and respect regardless of background, position, or role.

3.3 Accountability: Take ownership of your actions and their consequences. Report mistakes promptly.

3.4 Fairness: Make decisions based on merit and objective criteria, free from bias or favoritism.

3.5 Compliance: Follow all applicable laws, regulations, and company policies at all times.

4. Conflicts of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests conflict or appear to conflict with company interests. Examples include: (a) financial interest in a competitor or supplier, (b) accepting gifts over $100 in value from vendors, (c) hiring family members without disclosure and approval, (d) using company resources for personal financial gain. All potential conflicts must be disclosed to HR and the employee's manager. The Ethics Committee reviews disclosed conflicts within 14 days.

5. Confidentiality

Employees have access to confidential information including customer data, trade secrets, financial information, and personnel records. This information must be protected and not shared with unauthorized parties, including after employment ends. Confidentiality obligations survive termination of employment for 3 years.

6. Gifts & Entertainment

Employees may accept nominal gifts (under $50 value) from business partners as tokens of appreciation. Gifts over $50 must be declined or reported to HR. All business entertainment must have a legitimate business purpose, be reasonable in cost, and be approved by the employee's manager. Gifts of cash or cash equivalents are never acceptable regardless of amount.

7. Reporting Violations

Employees who witness or suspect violations of this policy must report through one of the following channels: (1) Direct manager, (2) HR Department, (3) Ethics Hotline (anonymous, 1-800-ETHICS1), (4) Legal Department. Retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith is strictly prohibited and will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

8. Disciplinary Action

Violations of this Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action ranging from written warning to termination of employment, depending on severity. Serious violations may also result in civil or criminal legal action. HR and Legal will determine appropriate discipline in consultation with management.

9. Acknowledgment

All employees are required to read, understand, and sign an acknowledgment of this Code of Conduct annually. New employees must sign during onboarding. Signed acknowledgments are retained in the employee's personnel file.